



March 6, 2023

REGIONAL ORDER

No. 0002-A s. 2023



SUBJECT: Updating Regional Order No. 0002s. 2023: Guidelines on the strengthening of High-risk/ Complicated pregnancy tracking and referral system for all Health Facility Catering Maternal and Newborn Services both Public and Private in SOCCSKSARGEN Region.

I. Background and Rationale:

Safe motherhood is an initiative that focuses on the health and well-being of a women throughout their pregnancy and childbirth. By achieving the program goal of reducing maternal and neonatal morbidity and mortality the need to improve maternal and neonatal health is vital. It includes the full range of essential health services, from promotion to prevention, treatment, rehabilitation and reassuring best of care for pregnant and newborn.

The region has a total adolescent birth rate of 39.39 for the year 2021 with a decreased of 1.44% compare to 2020 reported adolescent birth rate of 40.83. region is above the national target of 37/1000 group of female ages 15-19 years old. Teen pregnancy may cause to have a higher risk in giving birth at the early age and also the condition of the newborn might have a higher risk of mortality as well. The need to strengthening the adolescent friendly health facility in the region is highly recommended and must be use by the adolescent. A total of 239 health facility has been certified as level 1 and a total of 71 health facility for level 2 and 314 health facility for level 3 Adolescent Friendly Health Facility (AFHF).

For the year 2021, a total of 42 cases of maternal deaths reported in SOCCSKSARGEN Region with a maternal mortality rate of 64.35/100,000LB compared to 56.95 in 2020. An increase of 7.4% indicates that there are some inequalities in access to quality health services in the region. Maternal Death Review (MDR) findings shows that there are factors affecting utilization and outcomes such as the socio-economic and cultural factors, accessibilities of facilities and the quality of care. Another factor which contributed to direct maternal cause of death is the late identification of high-risk or complicated pregnancy and